Yiheda Automation (301029.SZ): 3Q26 beat led by electronics and semiconductor exposure; Buy

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Post Oct 26 market close, Yiheda reported 3Q26 results that came in above our expectations. The company's 3Q26 revenue/operating profit/net profit recorded Rmb1,116mn/232mn/201mn, +52%/+62%/+48% yoy, which is +23%/+46%/+32% vs. GSe, mainly due to: 1) stronger-than-expected consumer electronics demand (incl. AI-related applications) that held up beyond the seasonal 2Q peak; 2) further acceleration in semiconductor (+100%+ yoy); and 3) resilient lithium battery demand (+20-30% yoy). GPM/OPM/NPM was 40%/21%/18%, -0.7pp/+1.3pp/-0.4pp yoy and +0.1pp/+3.2pp/+1.2pp vs. GSe. Looking into 4Q26E, mgmt. noted that consumer electronics demand remained stable in October and expects solid near-term yoy growth, while lithium battery demand is expected to be weaker than in 1-3Q26 on a high 4Q25 base. Overall, we expect revenue growth to slightly moderate in 4Q26E from 3Q's +52% yoy, as lithium normalization partly offsets consumer electronics/semis momentum. Yiheda also continued to advance its FB business, with a focus on brand awareness and AI-enabled drawing recognition/programming efficiency. **We revise up 2026E-30E EPS by an average of 7%** to reflect 3Q26 results but **refine our target P/E multiple to 30X from 32X on slightly moderating earnings CAGR ahead into 2027-2030E** due to battery exposure. **Accordingly, our new 12-m TP moves up to Rmb35.80 (vs. Rmb 35.70 previously). Maintain Buy.**

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Exhibit 1: Yiheda 3Q26 financial summary

Yiheda (301029.SZ)	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	yoy	qoq	Prior 3Q26 Gse	Diff 3Q26
Revenue (Rmb mn)	736	751	746	1,107	1,116	52%	1%	906	23%
Gross profit (Rmb mn)	296	287	291	431	442	49%	3%	358	23%
EBIT (Rmb mn)	143	84	144	219	232	62%	6%	158	46%
Net profit (Rmb mn)	136	95	129	189	201	48%	6%	152	32%
EPS (Rmb)	0.21	0.15	0.20	0.30	0.32	48%	6%	0.24	32%
Gross margin (Rmb mn)	40%	38%	39%	39%	40%	-0.7pp	0.7pp	40%	0.1pp
EBIT margin (Rmb mn)	19%	11%	19%	20%	21%	1.3pp	0.9pp	18%	3.2pp
Net margin (Rmb mn)	18%	13%	17%	17%	18%	-0.4pp	0.9pp	17%	1.2pp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The author would like to thank Zhou Li, Hao Chen, Zhihan Ye and Junfang Zhang for their contribution to this report.

We attended the post-results conference call and our key takeaways are:

- **Downstream divergence continued in 1-3Q26**, led by lithium battery/consumer electronics/semiconductor, which contributed 24%/21%/9% of revenue and grew +42%/+25%/+100%+ yoy, while auto remained soft at 9% of revenue and flat yoy. Implied 3Q26 growth for lithium battery/consumer electronics/auto/semiconductor was c. +20-30%/+40+%/+HSD%/+100+% yoy, with respective revenue contributions of c.20%/20%+/c.9%/9%+.
  - **Lithium battery** recorded 1-9M26 revenue of close to Rmb700mn, driven by customers' capacity expansion, higher product coverage and new product introductions. Mgmt. expects weaker demand in 4Q26 vs. 1-3Q26, with a high 4Q25 base and deteriorating demand for traditional power battery equipment. Solid-state/other battery technologies remain potential sources of new demand, with applications in new cell packaging, corrosion-resistant and insulating structures.
  - **Consumer electronics** contribution was 20%+ in 3Q26, with growth accelerating to +40%+ yoy. Demand sustained, with Apple's new models driving continued equipment procurement for assembly/components/ultra-thin glass/thermal structural parts. Meanwhile, the AI infrastructure ramp-up drove server-related demand, with incremental orders from overseas end-customers and the Foxconn-led domestic supply chain. Looking into 4Q26, mgmt. sees stable demand in October and solid near-term yoy growth, though visibility remains limited given short order lead time.
  - **Semiconductor** recorded 1-3Q26 revenue of Rmb200mn+, +100%+ yoy, making up c.9% of total revenue. Yiheda aims to broaden the customer base through market share expansion and domestic substitution, supported by a newly established semiconductor BU and on-site engineering teams at key customers. Mgmt. sees upside in back-end packaging/testing and related equipment from AI supply chain expansion, alongside import substitution opportunities arising from core component shortages.

- **Margins remained resilient:** 3Q26 GPM/NPM was c.40%/18%, down 0.7pp/0.4pp yoy. Separately, the 1-3Q26 period expense ratio rose 1.27pp yoy to 18.32%, driven by higher staff costs and share-based compensation expenses. Looking forward, mgmt. expects GPM to remain stable by 1) focus on high margin long-tail, small-batch demand; 2) product mix optimization and scale expansion; 3) process improvements and product coverage expansion.
- **FB (non-standardized products)** achieved Rmb117mn revenue in 1-3Q26, +54% yoy (vs. Rmb76mn in 1-9M25). Mgmt. targets c.Rmb150mn FB revenue for FY26, with a focus on building brand awareness through existing sales channels/customers and facilitating faster order placement. Yiheda is also actively leveraging AI to improve drawing recognition and programming efficiency while exploring external software solutions to further enhance these functions.

Valuation:

We revise up 2026E-30E EPS by an average of 7% to reflect 3Q26 results but refine our 2027E target P/E multiple to 30X from 32X on slightly moderating earnings CAGR ahead into 2027-2030E due to battery exposure. **Accordingly, our new 12-m TP moves up to Rmb35.80 (vs. Rmb 35.70 previously). Maintain Buy.**

Downside risks: (1) Slower-than-expected SKU expansion; (2) Weak FA demand; (3) intense competition.

Investment Thesis, Price Target, Risks & Methodology

Investment Thesis - Yiheda Automation

We are positive on Yiheda Automation's business model to modernize China's manufacturing and factory automation (FA) supply chain, as it drives the move away from traditional mom & pop hardware stores and distributors by offering enhanced efficiency and lower costs for manufacturers. The company provides concrete benefits for clients such as: convenient online and offline channels, diverse SKUs, on-demand CAD configuration, professional technology support, agile supply chain management and competitive pricing. We are Buy rated on Yiheda with potential catalysts being faster SKU expansion/strong FA demand/better operational performance than overseas peers.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Yiheda Automation

Price target: Our 12m target price of Rmb35.8 is based on a 2027E P/E of 30x.

Downside risks: (1) Slower-than-expected SKU expansion; (2) Weak FA demand; (3) intense competition.

301029.SZ	12m Price Target: **Rmb35.80**	Price: **Rmb26.33**	Upside: **36.0%**

Buy

Market cap: Rmb16.7bn / $2.5bn
Enterprise value: Rmb15.4bn / $2.3bn
3m ADTV: Rmb205.0mn / $30.5mn
China
China Industrial Tech & Machinery
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	**2,948.0**	**3,979.8**	**4,671.1**	**5,473.3**
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	2,948.0	3,678.5	4,334.0	5,069.7
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	611.7	800.8	919.5	1,061.4
EPS (Rmb) New	**0.81**	**1.01**	**1.19**	**1.38**
EPS (Rmb) Old	0.81	0.93	1.11	1.29
P/E (X)	31.7	26.1	22.1	19.1
P/B (X)	3.7	3.5	3.1	2.8
Dividend yield (%)	2.5	1.1	1.4	1.6
CROCI (%)	19.9	35.5	20.8	21.3

	6/26	9/26	12/26E	--
EPS (Rmb)	0.30	0.32	0.19	–

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 26 Oct 2026 close.

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Reg AC

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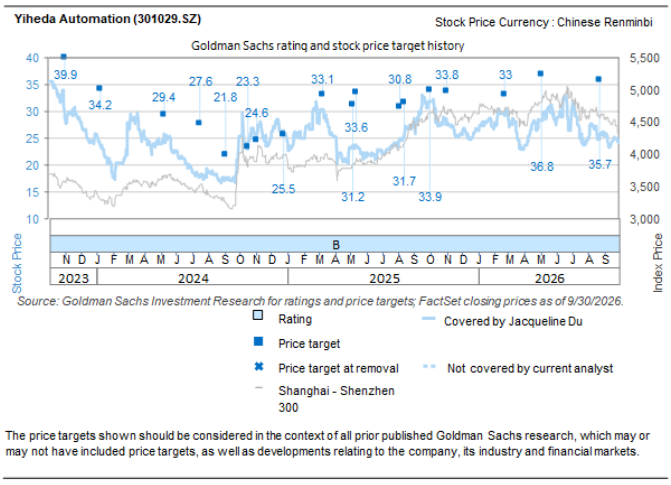
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Target price history table(s)
Yiheda Automation (301029.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
25-Aug-26	35.70	25.86
05-May-26	36.80	28.34
24-Feb-26	33.00	29.08
03-Nov-25	33.80	28.42
02-Oct-25	33.90	31.91
15-Aug-25	31.70	27.20
06-Aug-25	30.80	25.00
13-May-25	33.60	23.40
07-May-25	31.20	23.34
11-Mar-25	33.10	30.45
26-Dec-24	25.50	26.38
04-Nov-24	24.60	25.55
18-Oct-24	23.30	24.29
05-Sep-24	21.80	17.72
18-Jul-24	27.60	17.98
09-May-24	29.40	25.73
08-Jan-24	34.20	23.49
01-Nov-23	39.90	29.01

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